

Delphine Merriwether

Character Dossier

Boisterous, generous, easily bored salvage pilot of the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light

Overview

Delphine Merriwether is a salvage pilot living in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light. Delphine is 45 years old, originally from Little Ashby, and is known around the big top as boisterous, generous, easily bored. In conversation Delphine speaks in short, clipped sentences and dislikes being rushed.

Background

Delphine arrived in the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light 30 years ago after leaving Little Ashby under circumstances Delphine describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Ringmaster's troupe; the second was the one that stuck. Today Delphine works as a salvage pilot near the menagerie wagons and is paid, when paid at all, in copper bits.

Delphine learned the trade from Wilhelmina Duskmere, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Delphine's life is with Qadira Lindqvist, over a matter neither will explain. The person Delphine trusts most is Torvald Nightingale.

Current goal: to build a boat with no nails in it. Greatest fear: the bells at midnight.

Personality and speech

Temperament: boisterous, generous, easily bored.

Speech pattern: Delphine speaks in short, clipped sentences and dislikes being rushed.

Tells: when lying, Delphine mentions Pockets the cat for no reason.

Verified facts

These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.

Full name	Delphine Merriwether
Role	salvage pilot
Home	the traveling Circus of Marrow and Light
Hometown	Little Ashby
Age	45
Favourite dish	festival spiced pumpkin dumplings
Pet	Pockets, a cat
Lucky number	829

<i>Workshop password</i>	yarrow-quartz
<i>Mentor</i>	Wilhelmina Duskmere
<i>Rival</i>	Qadira Lindqvist
<i>Closest friend</i>	Torvald Nightingale

Secret

Delphine keeps a list of everyone who has ever been kind to them, and repays each one eventually.

Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Delphine: I am the salvage pilot. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Delphine: Festival spiced pumpkin dumplings. Do not tell Qadira I said so.

Visitor: Is Pockets yours?

Delphine: Pockets belongs to nobody. Pockets tolerates me. Lucky number is 829, if you were about to ask.

Chronicle

Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.

Entry 1, spring of year 29

An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the quarantine. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Delphine moved the oilskin map indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tariff on salt. A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the menagerie wagons; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 2, spring of year 29

Delphine repaired the grain scale at the costume tent for Pilar, who paid in 12 copper bits and a long story about the tariff on salt. Delphine repaired the sextant at the costume tent for Juniper, who paid in 47 copper bits and a long story about the price of lamp oil. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the harvest count. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 3, winter of year 29

A dispute over the missing shipment flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the big top; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Delphine moved the pair of spectacles indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the harvest count. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the singing at the docks. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. The weather turned. Delphine moved the oilskin map indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the harvest count. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not.

Entry 4, autumn of year 29

A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the cookfire; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. At the cookfire, Delphine taught a newcomer how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone. Delphine spent the day counting stock at the cookfire: 24 of everything, except the oilskin map, which is always short.

Entry 5, autumn of year 29

Vesna came by asking about who really won the regatta. Delphine said nothing useful and made tea instead. A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the ticket wagon; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. The weather turned. Delphine moved the bundle of letters indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about whether the bridge will hold. Delphine closed early, walked to the menagerie wagons, and watched the lights come on. Delphine won 8 copper bits on a bet about whether the bridge will hold and spent all of it on supper.

Entry 6, winter of year 29

Delphine closed early, walked to the menagerie wagons, and watched the lights come on. Delphine was hired to carry a ledger from the ticket wagon to the menagerie wagons without opening it, and

mostly succeeded. Delphine spent the day counting stock at the ticket wagon: 20 of everything, except the ledger, which is always short. Delphine repaired the glass float at the ticket wagon for Liora, who paid in 44 copper bits and a long story about the rumour of a second well.

Entry 7, spring of year 29

The weather turned. Delphine moved the grain scale indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the tax on doors. Delphine spent the day counting stock at the menagerie wagons: 21 of everything, except the hand bell, which is always short. Delphine won 37 copper bits on a bet about the tariff on salt and spent all of it on supper. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the menagerie wagons. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. A dispute over the census flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the menagerie wagons; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding.

Entry 8, summer of year 29

Delphine spent the day counting stock at the costume tent: 89 of everything, except the glass float, which is always short. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. Delphine was hired to carry a bundle of letters from the costume tent to the ticket wagon without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Delphine was hired to carry a sextant from the costume tent to the ticket wagon without opening it, and mostly succeeded. Delphine repaired the wax seal at the costume tent for Matthias, who paid in 85 copper bits and a long story about the tax on doors.

Entry 9, autumn of year 30

Delphine closed early, walked to the cookfire, and watched the lights come on. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the missing shipment. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. At the costume tent, Delphine taught a newcomer how to tell a real glass float from a fake one by weight alone. Delphine repaired the sack of salt at the costume tent for Anouk, who paid in 69 copper bits and a long story about the missing shipment.

Entry 10, spring of year 30

Delphine closed early, walked to the big top, and watched the lights come on. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tariff on salt for an hour and parted better friends than before. Delphine repaired the ledger at the cookfire for Gustav, who paid in 79 copper bits and a long story about who really won the regatta. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the harvest count for an hour and parted better friends than before. Delphine repaired the cracked compass at the cookfire for Tomasz, who paid in 52 copper bits and a long story about the quarantine.

Entry 11, spring of year 30

Delphine found a bolt of linen half-buried near the ticket wagon and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the missing shipment for an hour and parted better friends than before. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the rumour of a second well for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 12, winter of year 30

A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the ticket wagon; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. A stranger asked Delphine for the password to the workshop. Delphine laughed and said it was written on the wall, which it is not. At the ticket wagon, Delphine taught a newcomer how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone. Someone left a cracked compass on the doorstep with no note. Delphine has a suspect and is probably right.

Entry 13, winter of year 30

A dispute over whether the bridge will hold flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the cookfire; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Delphine repaired the copper pipe at the cookfire for Dorothea, who paid in 59 copper bits and a long story about the old tunnels. Delphine found a signal flag half-buried near the cookfire and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

Entry 14, spring of year 30

Delphine spent the day counting stock at the cookfire: 45 of everything, except the sack of salt, which is always short. Someone left a sack of salt on the doorstep with no note. Delphine has a suspect and is probably right. The weather turned. Delphine moved the coil of rope indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the census. Delphine closed early, walked to the ticket wagon, and watched the lights come on. Rumours about the singing at the docks reached the cookfire. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 15, autumn of year 30

Delphine repaired the clockwork bird at the menagerie wagons for Kenji, who paid in 85 copper bits and a long story about the harvest count. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the tariff on salt. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Delphine won 88 copper bits on a bet about the comet and spent all of it on supper. Delphine spent the day counting stock at the menagerie wagons: 84 of everything, except the coil of rope, which is always short.

Entry 16, spring of year 30

the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the missing shipment. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Delphine spent the day counting stock at the menagerie wagons: 88 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the price of lamp oil for an hour and parted better friends than before.

Entry 17, autumn of year 31

Delphine won 45 copper bits on a bet about the quarantine and spent all of it on supper. Rumours about the tax on doors reached the costume tent. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the tax on doors for an hour and parted better friends than before. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the new curfew for an hour and parted better friends than before. Delphine spent the day counting stock at the costume tent: 13 of everything, except the iron kettle, which is always short.

Entry 18, autumn of year 31

A dispute over the harvest count flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the menagerie wagons; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Delphine won 82 copper bits on a bet about

the old tunnels and spent all of it on supper. At the menagerie wagons, Delphine taught a newcomer how to tell a real clockwork bird from a fake one by weight alone. Rumours about the comet reached the menagerie wagons. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it.

Entry 19, summer of year 31

Rumours about the tax on doors reached the costume tent. Delphine pretended not to care and then asked everyone about it. At the costume tent, Delphine taught a newcomer how to tell a real tin whistle from a fake one by weight alone. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before. the Ringmaster's troupe sent a notice about the price of lamp oil. Delphine read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table.

Entry 20, spring of year 31

The weather turned. Delphine moved the signal flag indoors and wrote three lines to an old friend about the rumour of a second well. A dispute over the tariff on salt flared up between Delphine and a neighbour outside the ticket wagon; it ended, as usual, with neither of them conceding. Delphine closed early, walked to the menagerie wagons, and watched the lights come on. An old teacher visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before.